

Committee: Human Rights Council

Topic: Rebuilding Human Rights Frameworks After Global Disruption: Displacement, Survival, and the Ethics of Humanitarian Protection

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Introduction

All and any armed conflicts, pandemics, natural disasters, and economic crises can and count as global disruptions. Thus, they have been significantly affecting international human rights systems while at the same time as well creating new challenges for humanitarian protection. This affects multiple people at once since it forces them to leave their homes and be left without reliable access to safety, healthcare, food, shelter, education, and legal protection from others. However, there have been some international frameworks established to address such global disruptions, for example the Universal Declaration of Human Rights and the 1951 Refugee Convention, which were able to implement fundamental rights and protection for those individuals and communities that were impacted by global disruptions. Nevertheless, these international frameworks are as well able to still significantly impact governments and humanitarian organisations when they are facing challenges such as resource shortages and overwhelming demand for those in need.

Key Words

Global disruptions - Events that seriously impact societies and countries. Example: wars, natural disasters, economic crises, pandemics.

Armed Conflicts - Situation where a group or countries use military force against one or another member.

International human rights system - International laws and institutions created to protect people's basic human rights.

Humanitarian protection - Action taken to protect individuals during or after a serious event.

Reliable access - Consistent ability to obtain a certain object. (In this case: healthcare, food, shelter, safety)

International framework - Agreement and law agreed on internationally to address an issue and protect people's rights.

Universal Declaration of Human Rights - A 1948 United Nations declaration that gives fundamental human rights and freedoms for all people.

Fundamental Rights - Basic rights that every person has.

Internationally Displaced Person (IDP) - An individual who has been forced to leave their home because of a conflict, violence, disasters, or other crises, but remain within their borders.

General Overview

When a Global disruption happens, it usually means that a major event has happened that seriously impacts governments and essential services over a large area. And since it happens not in one place but in multiple areas at the same time, it makes it really hard to control and give immediate support, leading to many people needing help at the same time. Due to this, multiple essential services get affected, such as healthcare, education, transportation, and government support, which then leads to even further spread of the impact area. That's why the sooner people respond to global disruption, the fewer people get affected by it. And, during these times, people affected have a greater chance of having their human rights violated and losing their safety for a certain period of time. Hospitals and other government services become unavailable or overcrowded, making it hard to receive help.

However, an international agreement was created that governments are expected to follow when an event like this happens. For example, the Universal Declaration of Human Rights is a 1948 UN declaration that states fundamental rights for people in any situation. It defines basic human rights and applies to all people regardless of who they are. On the other hand, the 1951 Refugee Convention is an international treaty that only applies to refugees who are impacted by a global crisis. It establishes responsibilities for states towards refugees. Other international organizations help implement these rules even with the limited resources that the affected area has during the crisis.

Moreover, while the existing frameworks for human rights and refugee protection are ideal for global destruction situations, they cannot be qualified as being perfect and still require further improvements and future betterment. For example, during the crisis, those who are in need of support are not always the ones who are and will be prioritised, which therefore can ultimately even further worsen the impact on the already affected populations.

After the immediate effects and consequences of a global disruption have taken place and decreased over time, governments and international corporations should as well focus on rebuilding the systems that aim to protect human rights. These can include focusing on restoring healthcare and education, replacing lost identity documents, rebuilding legal and government institutions, and supporting displaced people who have been able to return to their communities while helping others to return. Most importantly, it's necessary to prevent discrimination against displaced populations and improve emergency systems so that countries are better prepared for any future possible crisis. Hence, humanitarian protection should not only focus on immediate survival, but as well restoring long-term access to basic rights and services.

Major Parties Involved

UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC) - Part of the UN, Focused on international human rights.

UN High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) - UN group of people responsible for refugees and displaced people.

National Governments - People responsible for their state population and territory.

UN Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (UN OCHA) - Part of the UN responsible for humanitarian emergencies.

International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC) - Humanitarian organisation responsible for armed conflicts

International Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) - Organisations providing support in global disruption situations.

Timeline of Relevant Events

Year	Event
1948	Adoption of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR)
1949	Agreement on Four Geneva Conventions

1950	Establishment of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR)
1951	Adoption of the 1951 Refugee Convention
1967	Adoption of the 1967 Refugee Protocol
1977	Adoption of the First and Second additional protocols were added to the Geneva Convention
2005	UN Member States affirm the Responsibility to Protect (R2P)
2015	European Refugee Crisis
2020	Covid-19 Pandemic

Relevant Documents

[Universal Declaration of Human Rights](#): International human rights declaration
The foundation of human-rights protection.

[Fourth Geneva Convention, 1949](#): International humanitarian law
Relevant to protecting people affected by war and conflicts

[Convention relating to the Status of Refugees](#): International Refugee protection treaty
States the refugee rights and the foundation of them

[The 1951 Convention and 1967 Protocol relating to the Status of Refugees](#) (The 1967 Protocol)
Continuation of the 1951 Refugee Convention

[International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights \(ICCPR\)](#): International human rights treaty
Covers important human rights during global crises

Possible Solutions

Despite many challenges that we face regarding human rights during global disruption, there are several solutions to this.

1. *Improve communication between governments so that when a global disruption happens, there can be a faster response to the situation.*

If people respond faster to the global disruption, this can lead to minimizing the effect that it causes. Therefore, fewer people get hurt, and fewer resources are spent.

2. *Better cooperation between leaders and fewer arguments about resources.*

One of the reasons why global disruption takes place is because of wars and armed conflicts. This could lead to fewer arguments and less tension between global leaders.

3. Global disruption fast response group.

This means that in each country or major city, there could be a fast response group or a team whose purpose is to minimise the negative effect that may be caused by any unexpected event. For instance, certain or all states could develop a national rapid response method or a mechanism that could help coordinate government agencies, humanitarian organizations, and healthcare providers during any major crisis. These mechanisms could help to identify displaced populations, help coordinate emergency assistance, while at the same time ensuring that essential services, such as healthcare, food, shelter, and documentation remain accessible.

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